

explore why traditional cloud security approaches may not adequately address the evolving threat landscape. Why do organisations face difficulties mitigating cloud threats despite adhering to security best practices? What potential gaps exist by sticking to traditional cloud security practices? We'll also introduce the concept of 'enterprise cloud security governance strategy' and how it can potentially address the challenges.

The popularity of cloud and its security implications

Over the past decade, enterprises have rushed to embrace cloud technology, enticed by its unmatched flexibility and scalability. Initially, most organisations prioritised their core business objectives, often neglecting security. However, as they established sustainable operations in the cloud, they confronted increasingly sophisticated cyber threats.

A significant factor contributing to this challenge is the frequent oversight or undervaluation of security during the transitional phase. Some organisations hesitated to allocate additional resources, efforts, and overheads to implement comprehensive security measures, fearing uncertain returns on investment. Consequently, they opted for a minimalist approach, hoping to navigate the complexities with minimal investment.

On the flip side, many enterprises diligently adhere to best practices, promptly addressing security issues identified by their tools and services. This proactive approach often leads them to believe that their security measures are mature enough to fend off cyber threats. Their confidence is rooted in a reliance on conventional security paradigms, including the deployment of tools like cloud security posture management (CSPM), application deployment through secure pipelines or the utilisation of native services provided by cloud service providers (CSPs), such as firewalls, network protection, *et al.* However, the reality

Cybersecurity: A few facts

- **Inevitability of cyberattacks:** Regardless of an organisation's size or the maturity of its security, the threat of cyberattacks is inevitable.
- **Sophisticated attack vectors:** Hackers continuously innovate and adapt, often outpacing the capabilities of traditional security defences. Their sophisticated methods and techniques enable them to penetrate even the most secure systems.
- **Flexibility vs security:** Defending against these sophisticated threats is a multifaceted challenge. While organisations invest in various security measures, the flexibility of modern IT environments makes it difficult to maintain a comprehensive security posture.
- **Blind spots:** Security breaches can go undetected for extended periods, allowing attackers to operate stealthily within an organisation's network. In many cases, the lack of effective monitoring and detection mechanisms contributes to these gaps.
- **Evolution of security alongside attacks:** Cybersecurity is not a one-time investment but an ongoing process of adaptation and improvement. Organisations must consistently evaluate their security stance and adjust their defences to counter evolving threats.

of security readiness in the cloud environment is far more complex than is initially perceived.

Enterprise security challenges

When it comes to cyber security in the cloud, a few important questions need to be answered.

- Why do security breaches occur despite organisations diligently implementing stringent security measures?
- Why do organisations struggle to comply with regulations and standards like GDPR, PCI, etc? What aspects have they overlooked in their current approaches to compliance?
- What are the obstacles to effectively mitigating cloud security risks? How can an efficient risk management strategy be developed to address these challenges?
- Why do enterprises often remain reactive in responding to cyber attacks? What steps can they take to transition to proactive threat mitigation?
- Do the current security controls provide comprehensive protection across the entire enterprise landscape? What contributes to gaps in the security posture? How can these gaps be mitigated effectively? Despite the confidence in their security

measures, organisations often find it challenging to address these critical questions. They frequently underestimate the criticality of their security posture until they experience a major breach or fail to comply with regulations.

Enterprise cloud environments are inherently complex, involving the utilisation of multiple cloud accounts, regions, environments, business units, applications, and more. The stakeholders engaged with these cloud environments interact with them using various approaches. The security and operations stakeholders, too, look at security from different perspectives to protect across different layers of the enterprise. This diversity often leads organisations to adopt distributed approaches to security. However, without a unified strategy, managing security across the enterprise becomes increasingly complex. Therefore, a cohesive security governance strategy is indispensable to align these disparate approaches and ensure comprehensive protection against evolving cyber threats.

Gaps in traditional cloud security approaches

Adhering to traditional cloud security approaches across any enterprise cloud security requirement is like fitting the